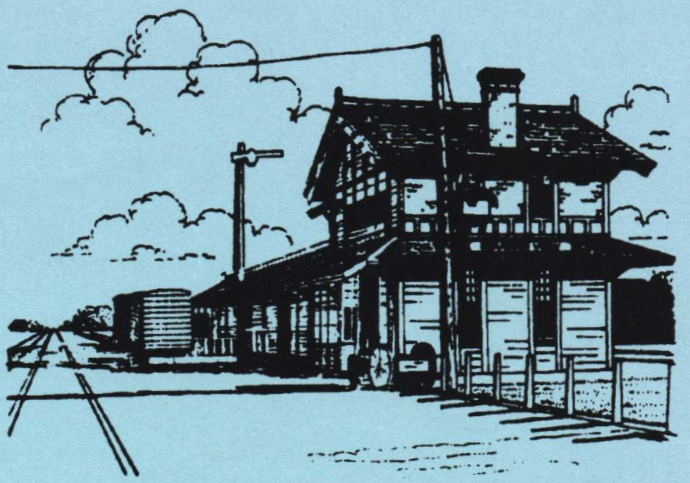
Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1888

Where It All Started
Silicon Valley & The Barn
The November Meeting

In 1947 William Shockley, John Bardeen and Walter Brattain developed the transistor, the basic device for the semiconductor industry. They were awarded the Nobel Prize in Physics for this work. In 1955 Shockley moved to Palo Alto and recruited a team of engineers and scientists to work for a new company, Shockley Semiconductor. Shockley opened his research and manufacturing facility in a building located at 391 San Antonio Road in Mountain View, adjacent to the San Antonio Mall. A spinoff from Shockley Semiconductor was Fairchild Semiconductor, the birthplace of the integrated circuit. Nearly every semiconductor and integrated circuit company in the Bay area can trace its origins to 391 San Antonio, known as *"The Barn"* to those who worked there. The Electronics Industry, which was well established in the Bay Area, and two great universities provided a pool of great talent which Shockley was initially able to organize and direct.

Your automobile, your electronic coffee maker, your cellular phone, your home computer, your television set, would all be impossible in their present form without the semiconductor devices and integrated circuits which stem from work begun at *the barn*. Without *the barn* the area might well be known as *electron gulch*, but *Silicon Valley*, with its tens of thousands of skilled workers would be vastly different.

The Mountain View Historical Association has been asked by the Mountain View City Council to consider jointly sponsoring some sort of historical marking for *the barn*. Our speaker, Consulting Engineer Jacques Beaudouin, worked for several years with William Shockley at *the barn*, and has been a long time advocate for memorializing the structure. The November meeting is your opportunity to gain some insight into the origins of what may be the most profound revolution of modern times.

Barbecue & Raffle
The August Meeting

The August meeting was the Fifth Annual Barbecue & Raffle for the Mountain View Historical Association. We again met on the patio adjacent to our regular meeting place at the Mountain View Senior Center. The weather was just about perfect for a summer outdoor event, although perhaps a trifle hot. Art Walton delivered as usual with a superb potato salad, and Al Jehning did his magic at the grill. (The day and the fire were hot enough to grill Al as well as the hamburgers!) It was a great party! Mark your calendars for the Sixth Annual Barbecue & Raffle, August 1, 1999!

The success of the Annual Barbecue and Raffle is due to the generous support of many Mountain View

Businesses and individuals. You will find many of them listed elsewhere in this Newsletter. It wouldn't work without the generous contributions of time and energy of Ralph Faravelli, Edna Thompson and Wally Erichsen. Just plain muscle in setting up and taking down was supplied by Joe Cusimano, Charles Thompson, Barbara Kinchen and a bunch of others. Everyone pitched in and we got compliments from the Senior Center Staff for the way we cleaned up!

Extra Hands Make Light Work

Thanks to Liz Ambra, Carmen and Ralph Faravelli, Cas Winder, Betty Engberg and Barbara kitchen who set up and staffed a display at the recent Antique Show on Castro Street. There were many interesting conversations about our Castro Street pictures. Sales of postcards, notepaper and booklets totaled $65.25.

Thanks to Betty Engberg, George Holden, Barbara Kinchen and Edna Thompson who set up, staffed, answered questions and sold at the All Mountain View High School Reunion in Cuesta Park. We earned $61.00 for our treasury.

Street Talk

The August Street Talk Puzzler was: *Evelyn Avenue before the mid 1950s carried what name?*
Several persons at the Antique Show and at the MV High School Reunion had the answer, and of course Lennart Ahlkvist (now of Coulterville) responded within days of publication with the correct response. The answer is, the street now known as *Evelyn Avenue* used to be *Front Street.*

For this issue puzzler is: *Cousins, Margaret Sharp Peterson and George Holden, lived for a number of years on Main Street. This is now incorporated into which expressway?*

MVHA 1998 Elections
Nominating Committee Report

It is time to elect officers for the 1999/2000 biennium. In accordance with our bylaws, a nominating committee was selected at the August meeting, charged with selecting a slate of candidates for MVHA Office. The Nominating Committee consisted of Barbara Kinchen, Edna Thompson and Wallace Erichsen (Chair). The Committee's nominees are as follows:

President	***Ralph Faravelli***
Vice President	***John Viscovich***
Secretary	***Eva Mockbee***
Treasurer	***June de Larios***

The bylaws specify that nominations for each office may be made from the floor at the annual meeting. Therefor, if you are a member of the Association and would like to nominate someone else for any of the Association offices, feel free to do so.

Don't forget to vote!
Elections are Tuesday, November 3, 1998

A Special Set of Memories
by Carol Fischer

The Mountain View Historical Association is lucky to have many members who are descendants of pioneer Mountain View families. One of our members, Roberta Bubb Sweeney, has recently written biographies of her parents: Elanor Mabel Cooper Bubb and William Franklin Bubb.

Roberta's grandfather, Benjamin T. Bubb, arrived on foot from Missouri in 1850 two weeks before California became a state. The family arrived in Mountain View in 1851. Benjamin and wife, Josephine, had seven children. Their second son, William, was Roberta's father. On his 120 acres, Benjamin first planted wheat. It wasn't until 1889, one year after Benjamin's death from a farm accident, that the Bubb family planted its first prune trees. Soon their entire land became an orchard of prune and apricot trees. Because William's siblings chose careers outside of ranching, it became William's responsibility to tend to the Bubb acreage.

The Bubbs were active members of the Cumberland Presbyterian Church located on Castro Street. It was here that William met, courted and married Elanor Cooper in 1908. Roberta and sister Frances were born a few years later. The Bubb family home was located at what is now Begen Avenue and Leona Lane. However, William and Elanor made their home at the corner of Grant Road and Cuesta Drive (once known as Bubb Road) — much of what is now occupied by St. Timothy's Episcopal Church.

It is interesting to read Roberta's first-hand account of a young girl growing up in Mountain View. Roberta recalls her father's difficulties of maintaining a successful fruit ranch. Spraying trees for insects and fungus and lighting smudge pots on frosty evenings was a dirty and smelly job. The Bubbs owned on of the first dehydrators in the Valley and were able to employ the local youth. During the summer, the girls were busy helping can fruits and vegetables. Roberta also describes how difficult it was to be an orchardist during the Great Depression. Mrs. Elise Haag, daughter of Henry Rengstorff, helped out the family when times were rough.

Roberta attended local schools, graduating from Mountain View High School in the early 1930's. She then continued her education at San Jose State. During this time, Roberta met a dashing young man from New Jersey who had come to Mountain View to work at the new Naval Air Station. Joe Sweeney and Roberta fell in love and were married in 1936, shortly after Roberta's graduation from college.

The Bubb family was active in the early beginnings of the little town of Mountain View. Their efforts contributed to the local economy; they worshiped at the local Presbyterian church; their children attended local schools (Roberta's father was a trustee for Mountain View High School); and both Roberta and Joe have been active in the Mountain View Historical Association. Thank you Roberta for making your memories a permanent record. We invite the members of the Historical Association to come to the Mountain View History Center to read Roberta's biographies. Our staff would enjoy sharing this special collection devoted to our City's heritage.

New to the Mountain View History Center
Compiled by Barbara Kinchen

From Zachary Calhoun: 1991 Quadrangle Map covering Mountain View area. Enlarged, laminated color copy of a map from the 1876 Thompson and West Historical Atlas. The two maps can be used to show changes in roads, creeks and other landmarks. Mr. Calhoun arranged for Art Oliver of Peninsula Blueprint, Inc. to copy and donate the earlier map.

From June (Redwine) de Larios: Framed phot with individual pictures of Fire Chief Clarence Lawson and 24 firemen. Photo of 1928 fire truck built by Redwine Motor Co. Postcard of Claude Redwine sitting in an auto in front of the Redwine Garage at 231 Castro Street, dated 1914.

From Bill Henderson: Bill is retiring ... again, and this time giving up his real estate office and has donated a number of items to the Historical Association. A partial list includes framed photos of an early Manfredi real estate office, 1922 Chamber of Com-

merce at Castro Street and El Camino Real and 1899 Mountain View telephone subscribers. Other items are on display in the Mountain View History Center.

From George Holden: 1973 Moffett Field Directory.

From Donald Hotl: Ship in a bottle, dated 1905, given him by Mrs. Anna (Jagels) Leu.

From Donald Lawson: Photo with Don's uncle, Clarence Lawson, displaying a large Canadian Goose he had shot. Also in the picture is Don's grandfather, Charles Lawson.

Mrs. Albert Pearson: Sixteen yearbooks from Mountain View High School within the years of 1911 to 1931.

Delphne Rush: Large 1960 poster with information about Mountain View — population, annual report and pictures of Councilmen.

From Roberta and Joe Sweeney: Two booklets about Roberta's parents, Elanor Mabel Cooper Bubb (1881-1967) and William Franklin Bubb (1874-1951). Also a copy of the high school newspaper, Mountain Eagle May 1933, and Programs for CSF banquets at high school.

On Display: In the Mountain View History Center is a framed pen and ink drawing of Cuesta Annex by artist Robert C. Schick. Robert is actively campaigning for the preservation of the Annex and has also brought in a piece from one of the old prune trees.

Speaking of Pictures: Are you enjoying those pictures from our collection in each issue of the ***Mountain View Voice?***



Executive Committee Meeting

The Executive Committee of the Mountain View Historical Association met September 4, 1998. The Membership Report is presented elsewhere in this Newsletter, but shows a net increase of five members over the last quarter. The Nominating Committee's Report is presented on page 2 of this Newsletter. Research for the hard cover *History of Mountain View* is proceeding on schedule, with the goal of publication in time for the Mountain View Centennial in 2002.

The *Friends of the Mountain View Library* operate a small Library Gift Shop in the new Library building. The Friends have earned the MVHA a profit of $267 from the sale of Historical Association note cards in the Gift Shop.

The City of Mountain View has asked the Historical Association to consider joint sponsorship of some sort of memorial to the origins of Silicon Valley at *The Barn*, located at 391 S. San Antonio. The November program is a beginning of that process.

Old Newspaper Items

Compiled By Barbara Kinchen

100 Years Ago (1898): The schoolhouse, church, gates and signs were the principle sufferers on Halloween when the younger element let their enthusiasm lead them into excess.

A 15 year old boy was committed to Whittier Reform School "because he would not go to school, smoked cigarettes and associated with bad characters.

While picking grapes, a rancher was bitten on the hand by a tarantula and hurried to the drug store to have the "poison burnt out." He was the fourth person bitten this season.

75 Years Ago (1923): "The trouble with being lazy is it requires so much time."

The entire volunteer fire department, including Chief F.L. Campen, threatened to resign when town trustees voted to buy a fire engine not to their liking.

Mountain View bought land for a park adjoining the City Hall, Castro and California Streets, from the Masonic Lodge for $6,500.

Mr. Perez, of the Perez & Holguerra Spanish grocery on the west side of Castro Street, can be seen through the front windows working at his cigarmaker's bench.

Minton Company has a total of 96 workers, including those in the Palo Alto and San Jose branch offices.

The Hung Heung Chinese Café was located at 638 Villa Street.

"Notice — Don't throw money in the fire. If you get letters or packages with foreign postage stamps, save the stamps and we will buy them. Do not cut or tear the stamps. Mail to us and we will send money by return mail. Fellowship Stamp Agency, Box 526 Mountain View, Calif."

50 Years Ago (1948): Anthony Calvelli, former "49er", has joined the coaching staff at the high school.

Chamber of Commerce sponsored the local stop of the Gaspar Portola Trek enactment. Ceremonies consisted of a parade, barbeque and drama put on by local residents in costume.

The Presbyterian Church on Castro Street, built in 1912, was condemned as unsafe and closed by a building inspector from the city.

Durham Meat Packing Company has located in the Union Ice Company building at Mariposa Avenue and the train tracks. It expects to employ 25 men to bone, pack and freeze a million pounds of meat monthly for shipping to government depots on the West coast. Knudsen Frozen Foods in the same building, has just finished processing the locally grown lima bean crop — approximately one million pounds. There are 48 workers at Knudsen.

Girl Scouts have leased Mockbee Hall, above Mountain View Hardware, for meetings and as headquarters for the local organization.

A small room at the back of the Library, on the second floor of City Hall, is being fitted up for a Sheriff's Sub-Station.

Perry Stratton is principal of the newly opened elementary school on Escuela Avenue.

Of the 50 cases of polio in Santa Clara county, 12 were from Mountain View, including two deaths.

25 Years Ago (1973): Ames Research Center held an "Open House", the first since joining the National Aeronautical and Space Administration (NASA0 in 1958.

Downtown merchants objected to the Castro Street Square Revitalization Committee's plan to ban auto traffic on Castro Street, between Villa and Evelyn Streets.

Gemco, a department store operation of Luck Stores, Inc., opened in September at 555 Showers Drive in the building which had formerly been occupied by Baza'r and later by Rhodes Way.

There were 176 applying for the six vacancies on the police force. The salary for rookie cops starts at $952.

The Sierra Club opposes further landfill operations at the site of the proposed Shoreline Regional Park.

1998 Annual Barbecue & Raffle Donors & Contributors

The Mountain View Historical Association is grateful to the following businesses and individuals whose generosity helped make the 1998 Annual Barbecue a great success:

Costco Wholesale
1000 N. Rengstorff Ave.
Hamburger Patties, Buns

Safeway
2580 California Ave.
Apple Pies

China Café
1760 Miramonte
Gift Certificate

In and Out MiniMart
1313 W. Camino Real
4 Hamburger Specials

Baskin-Robbins
1249 W. El Camino Real
5 Gift Certificates

Cusimano Family Mortuary
96 El Camino Real
Bottles of Wine

Edna Thompson
1031 Covington Road, LA
Bottle of Amoretto

Eva Mockbee
1879 Limetree Lane
Recipe Box, Steak Knives

Safeway
570 N. Shoreline Blvd.
Gift Certificate

Safeway
1750 Miramonte Ave.
Salad Fixings

Lucky Stores
580 N. Rengstorff
Gift Certificates

Golden Wok
595 Villa Street
Lunch for 2

Orchard Supply
2555 Charleston Road
Gift Certificates

Blossom Plaza Cleaners
1776 Miramonte Av.
Gift Certificate

Mr.&Mrs.Al Jehning
561 Carla Ct.
Charcoal, Cooking



SAVE THE ADOBE

Membership Report
by Edna Thompson

A list of members of the Mountain View Historical Association is available to members from the Chair of the Membership Committee. Dues are $ 7.00 per year for an individual or $10.00 per year for a family, and Life Membership is $100.00 per person.

Life Members	58
Special Member	1
Honored Member	1
Individual & Family Members	216
Total	276

New Members:

LeMora (Lynch) and Don Wiggan
Cindy and Larry Sue
Mary A. Loconte

Life Members

Mario Ambra
Marge Hingsberger Bailey
Godfrey Baumgartner
Dena K. Bonnell
Hilton Brown
Reynolds Camp
Cliff Del Carlo
Alfred P. Chasuk
Ruth Erichsen
Wallace Erichsen
Carmen Farvelli
Ralph Faravelli
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa
Carole Fischer
Marion Grimm
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Bill Henderson
Eleanor McGlynn Henderson
Charles Hirschbek
Norene Hogle
Alice D. Holden
George Holden
Donald M. Holt
Virginia M. Holt
George Jagels
Al Jehning
Robert W. Kirby
Joe Kleitman
Helen Shearer Krogh
Holly Urban Moore Leonard
Madeline Chargon Malovos
Eva Mockbee
Gail Urban Moore
LaVerna Vincent Morgan
Mimi Mourkas
Anne G. Nichols
Milan Popovich
John P. Puppo
Patricia J. Reyburn
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Nancy L. Smith
Richard M. Smith
Martin J. Spangler
Honor Spitz
J. R. Stafford
Brigitte Stafford
H. Lee Stillens
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Edna Thompson
Sally Moore Taboada
John Viscovich
Arthur Walton
Patricia Walton
Denise Williams
Bill Wissell

Association Officers and Board Members

President	Ralph Faravelli
Past President & Social	Wally Erichsen
Vice President	Arthur Walton
Secretary	Eva Mockbee
Treasurer	June de Larios
Membership	Edna Thompson
Newsletter & Program	Hilton Brown
Hospitality	Mary Esther Walton
Memorial/Remembrance	Margaret Peterson
Ways & Means	Joseph Sweeney
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification/Recording	Albert Jehning

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approx-imately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting. Short items on appropriate topics submitted by any member of the Association will be considered for publication.

Treasurer's Report
A.J. de Larios

July 1, 1998 - September 30, 1998

Balance 7/1/98		**$ 13,401.06**
Income		
Membership	$ 134.00	
Sales	310.20	
1998 BBQ	995.00	
Interest	9.23	
Total Income		1,448.43
Expense:		
Administration	$2,718.77	
1998 BBQ	317.53	
Total Expense		3,036.30
Balance 9/30/98		**$ 11,813.19**

Fund Balances:

Adobe Fund	$ 2,604.32
Memorial Fund	275.00
Life Member Fund	5,800.00
General Fund	3,133.87
Total Funds	**$ 11,813.19**

Investment:

C.D. $ 10,000.00 — 5.40% — Matures 7/99

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
REGULAR MEETING

Sunday, November 1, 1998
2:00 PM
Senior Center - 266 Escuela

Topic and Speaker

Where It All Started
Silicon Valley & The Barn

Presented by
Jacques Beaudouin
Consulting Engineer

MEMBERSHIP: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

AIMS: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

_____

TELEPHONE: _____

TYPE: NEW____ RENEWAL____

Regular Member $ 7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr
Life Member $100.00.

Make Check Payable to:

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P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

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P.O. BOX 252
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